Teacher and cover plan — Technique studio tasters

Pathway: TRACK · Week 1 Part 1 · Big question: How do four studio media change the mood and contrast of the same identity motif?

Learning goals and studio kit

• Test graphite tone, ink wash, dry pastel, and layered collage across a four-panel studio sheet.

• Compare how each medium handles sharp edges, smooth blending, and surface texture.

• Record a clear technical annotation under each panel naming strengths and control tips.

Studio kit: A3 four-panel studio sheet, 2B/4B graphite pencils, diluted ink and soft brush, chalk pastels, toned paper offcuts and glue

Arrival and starter

Arrival: Look at the four studio stations on your table. Which medium gives the sharpest edge control?

Starter question: Why do studio artists test the same motif across all four media before starting a final piece?

Teacher model (I do)

Step 1: Sketch the motif lightly in all four panels: I use a light H/2B line to place the same emblem at matching scale in Panels 1 to 4.

Step 2: Apply dry and wet tonal media (Panels 1-3): I build graded pencil tone in Panel 1, diluted ink wash in Panel 2, and blended chalk pastel in Panel 3.

Step 3: Construct the collage trial and annotate (Panel 4): I layer cut and torn tonal paper in Panel 4, then write one control note under each panel.

Practice routes (Supported / Independent / Aspire)

Supported: All four media panels completed with a completed observation stem under each.

Independent: Four distinct media studies completed with comparative technical annotations.

Aspire: Four single-medium panels plus a resolved hybrid mixed-media study and evaluation.

TA and cover notes

TA focus: Set up four clearly labelled media trays on each table and keep damp paper towels ready for fingers after using dry pastel.

Staff prep: Staff preparation only: review a short studio demonstration comparing graphite, ink wash, dry pastel, and tonal paper collage.